AI BUILD NOTES: WHOLESALESHOPPING.CO.UK HOMEPAGE REDESIGN

WholesaleShopping.co.uk homepage redesign · NaskSoft AI Web & CRO assessment · October 2026

TOOLS USED

Tool	What I used it for
Claude Code (Claude Opus 5.5), an AI coding agent in the terminal	Reading the brief, researching the live store and Fashion Nova, writing the plan, building the site (Astro, JavaScript, CSS), writing tests, reading Lighthouse reports, and drafting these notes from my build log
A **Claude Code helper agent**, run in the background	Collecting real, sourced facts about the store into `notes/real-facts.md`: Trustpilot score, delivery and dispatch times, VAT, minimum order, menus, FAQs
Playwright (a test tool Claude drove)	Screenshots of the current site, Fashion Nova and every build step; 55 automated tests at four screen sizes
Lighthouse	Speed and accessibility audits

MY PROCESS

1. **Understand the brief.** Claude read the PDF and turned it into checklists (`REQUIREMENTS.md`), with every requirement linked to a step in the plan.
2. **Research before designing.** Claude downloaded the live homepage, the store's public product data and Fashion Nova's homepage, then listed real problems:
   - 12 mixed menu items
   - banners with text baked into images
   - the page heading buried at the bottom
   - confusing pack prices
   - trust signals only in the footer

   And patterns worth borrowing from Fashion Nova: one offer bar, big search, category tiles, a tabbed product row, and Quick Add.
3. **Plan with checkpoints.** A phased plan (`PLAN.md`) with points where I reviewed the work, plus a `CLAUDE.md` file so every Claude session follows the plan and the rules (real facts only, mobile first).
4. **Use real data.** A script copies 70 real products (names, pack sizes, per-piece prices, photos) and the helper collected sourced facts. These facts changed the design:
   - The store blocks checkout under £100, so the bag shows that rule early.
   - The "Under £X" collections filter by pack price, so those tiles say "Packs under £X".
5. **Build in small steps.** After each step: screenshots at phone and desktop size, then fix what they showed. At checkpoint 1 I approved the look and asked for the real logo instead of a text one.

6. **Test and measure.**
    - Automated tests at four screen sizes.
    - A link checker for all 148 links.
    - Lighthouse.
    - Side-by-side before/after images.

PROMPTS AND ITERATION

A few of the prompts that shaped the project (spelling tidied):

1. *"Understand this assessment"* (with the PDF). → A summary of the task, the deliverables and the scoring. Claude pointed out that about 30% of the marks depend on these notes, so I kept a build log from the start.
2. *"Make an implementation plan first."* → The first answer was research findings and section ideas, not the step-by-step plan I wanted. I asked again: *"Implementation plan."* The second answer was a full plan file: stack, folders, specs with "done when" criteria, tests and risks.
3. *"Clone this repo ... and make an md file so the plan is added, so you can implement according to plan.md or requirements.md."* → `PLAN.md`, `REQUIREMENTS.md` and `CLAUDE.md` in the repo.
4. *"Yes, commit and push. Use the real logo."* → My feedback at checkpoint 1.
5. *"Start with the remaining phases"* and later *"No need to deploy, we'll use Netlify."* → Testing and fixing; I chose the hosting myself.

WHAT WENT WRONG

1. **A wrong assumption about the data.** Claude's product script assumed every product's size option was a pack size ("Pack of 3"). In fact 26 of the 70 products use "Regular / Plus Size". Some of those prices are for a whole pack: one product's address says "pack-of-6" and costs £24. Others are for one piece. The page would have shown wrong per-piece prices.
2. **The page was wider than the phone.** The newsletter section made the whole page lay out at 421 px on a 390 px phone, so a real phone would show it slightly zoomed out. **Claude's own test missed it**: it compared the page with `innerWidth`, which on phones grows to fit content that's too wide.
3. **The bottom bar hid the main buttons on phones.** All tests passed, because they only checked the buttons were inside the screen. I found the problem when I made the side-by-side comparison image for these notes. In the same image the offer bar read "deliveryon orders", because a layout change had removed the spaces.
4. **Slow pieces found by Lighthouse.**
    - On desktop, the slowest-loading element was the second hero photo. It was set to load lazily although it's on the first screen.
    - On phones, an 88 KB font file was competing with the hero photo for bandwidth.

HOW I FIXED IT

1. **Never invent a price.** Those 26 products show their price with "Regular & Plus sizes" and no per-piece figure, and the gap is listed as a follow-up.
2. **The layout and the test.** The grid columns can now shrink (`minmax(0, 1fr)`), and the test compares against the real screen width. Checked at 320, 360, 390, 768 and 1440 px.

3. **The buttons and the spaces.**
    - The hero's height now leaves room for the bottom bar, and the test checks against the bar.
    - The offer text is wrapped so the spaces stay, with a new test that checks the wording.
4. **Speed.**
    - Both desktop hero photos now load straight away.
    - The heading font is cut down to the one style the design uses (88 KB → 8 KB).
    - Photos come pre-cropped from Shopify's image server.

    Results: Lighthouse desktop performance went from 81 to 92 and phone from 90 to 91, with accessibility 100, best practices 100 and layout shift 0.

WHAT I LEARNED

- **Measure, don't just look.** Several bugs only showed up in numbers (a page 421 px wide, the slowest-loading element) or in a side-by-side image, not in a quick look at the screen.
- **A passing test can be wrong.** In my first test run, three of the four kinds of failure were mistakes in the tests. Two real bugs passed tests that measured the wrong thing.
- **CSS grid items won't shrink below their content** unless the column uses `minmax(0, 1fr)`.
- **Shopify's image server is very flexible.** It can resize and crop photos through the web address (`&width=…&height=…&crop=top`), and it automatically serves smaller WebP/AVIF files to browsers that support them.
- **In B2B, the store's real rules shape the design.** The £100 minimum and pack-price filters changed what the page says.
- **Be specific with AI.** "An implementation plan" got a strategy summary; asking for "a step-by-step plan with files, tasks and tests" got what I needed.

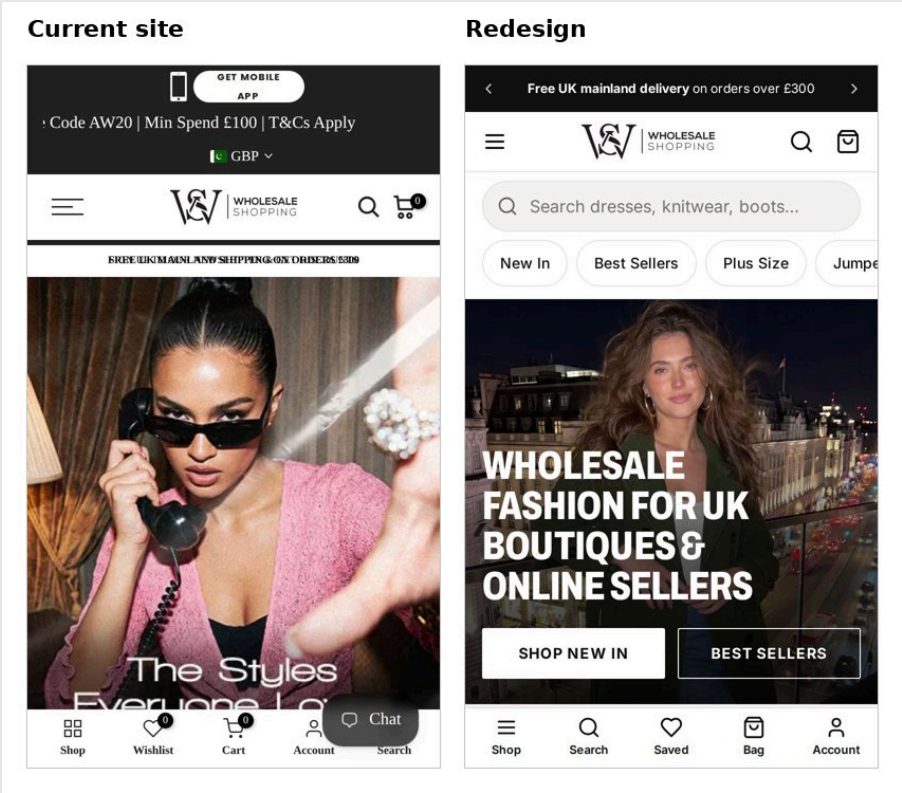
Results:

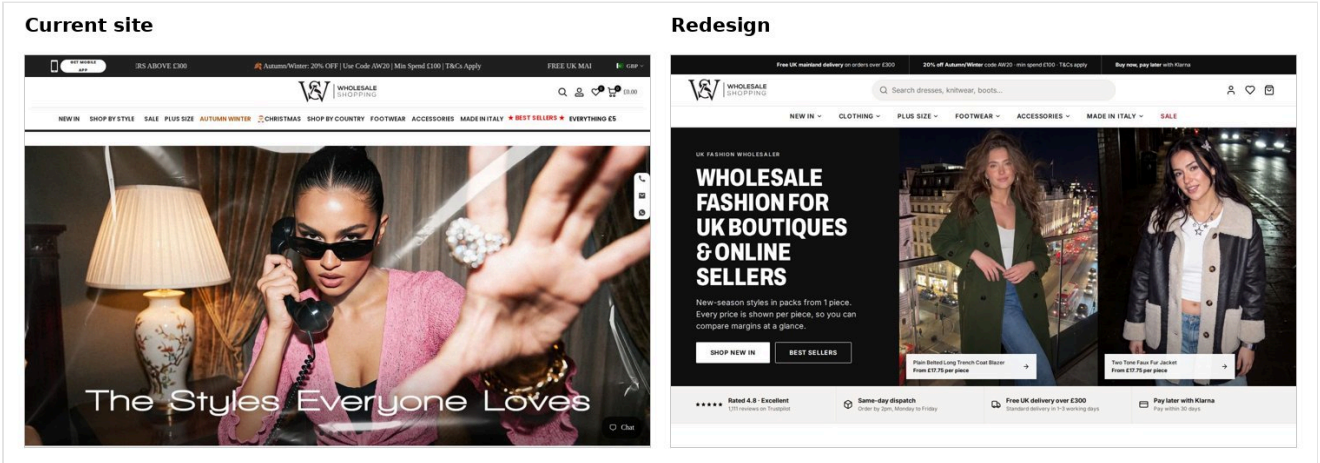
- 55 automated tests pass at four screen sizes.
- 146 of 148 links work and none are broken; the other 2 block automated checks and were checked by hand.
- Lighthouse on phones: performance 91, accessibility 100, best practices 100. On desktop: performance 92, accessibility 100, best practices 100.
- About 9 KB of JavaScript.

CRO DECISIONS: WHAT CHANGED FROM THE CURRENT HOMEPAGE, AND WHY

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The brief's question was: *what would make a fashion retailer arriving on this homepage more likely to browse products, find relevant stock and place an order?* Each change below answers part of it.





1. Say who it's for, above the fold

- **Problem:**
  - The hero is four picture-only slides, with the text baked into the images ("The Styles Everyone Loves") and no alt text.
  - On a phone that text is cut off, and the first screen has no button and no product.
  - The page's only main heading (H1) sits in a block of SEO text near the bottom.
- **Change:**
  - The hero has real text that says who the site is for: *"Wholesale fashion for UK boutiques & online sellers"*. This is now the H1.
  - A one-line pitch and two buttons, **Shop New In** and **Best Sellers**.
  - On phones both buttons fit on the first screen above the bottom bar (tested at 360 and 390 px wide).
- **Expected benefit:** trade buyers know in seconds they're in the right place, and there's an obvious next step, so fewer leave straight away. Search engines and screen readers can now read the message too.

2. Fewer, clearer menu choices

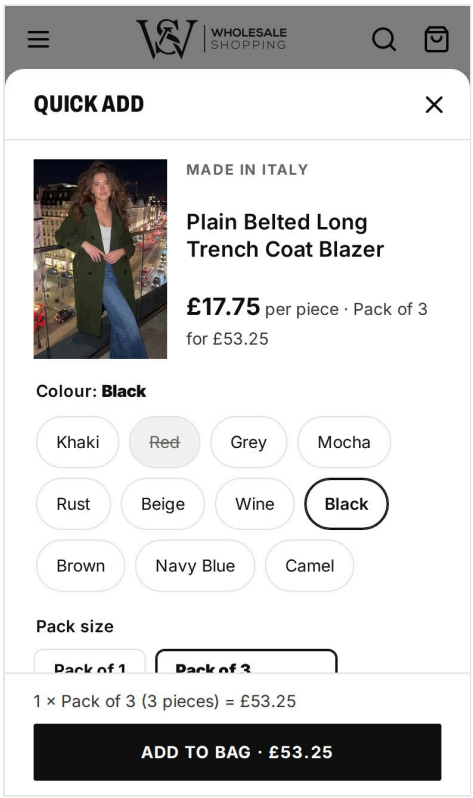
- **Problem:** 12 top menu items mix categories, seasons and offers, in three different text styles.
- **Change:**
  - **7 items:** New In, Clothing, Plus Size, Footwear, Accessories, Made in Italy, Sale.
  - Each has a mega menu that keeps all of the store's real categories, grouped by category, style, country and pack price.
  - On phones: a menu drawer with department tabs, plus one-tap chips under the search box (New In, Best Sellers, Plus Size, Jumpers…).
- **Expected benefit:** faster scanning and fewer wrong clicks. Phone buyers reach their category in one tap.

3. One clear offer bar instead of competing promotions

- **Problem:**
  - The top of the page stacks an app button, a scrolling AW20 ticker, a currency selector, and a strip alternating "free delivery" and "newsletter" messages (on a phone the two overlapped in our screenshot).
  - A Klarna ticker sits further down, and free delivery is announced twice.
- **Change:**
  - **One offer bar** with three real offers: free UK delivery over £300, 20% off Autumn/Winter with AW20, and pay later with Klarna.
  - Desktop shows all three. Phones rotate them slowly, pause on touch, and stop for visitors who switch off motion.
  - Seasonal offers become two photo banners with live text.
- **Expected benefit:** offers get noticed and understood, and there's less noise competing with the products.

4. Show prices the way resellers compare them

- **Problem:**
  - Product cards show confusing ranges such as *"£29.25 – £29.25 (Pack of 3 – Pack of 3)"*.
  - The "Under £4.99 … £19.99" collections filter by **pack** price, but nothing says so.
  - VAT isn't mentioned on the storefront, although the T&Cs say prices exclude VAT.
- **Change:**
  - Cards lead with the **price per piece** ("From £17.75 per piece"), then the pack ("Pack of 3 · £53.25"), the number of colours, and badges (New, Made in Italy, Plus Size).
  - Price tiles say **"Packs under £X"**.
  - "Prices per piece, excluding VAT" appears by the product row and in the bag.
- **Expected benefit:** buyers can compare margins at a glance and trust the numbers. More product views turn into adds.



5. More products, sooner

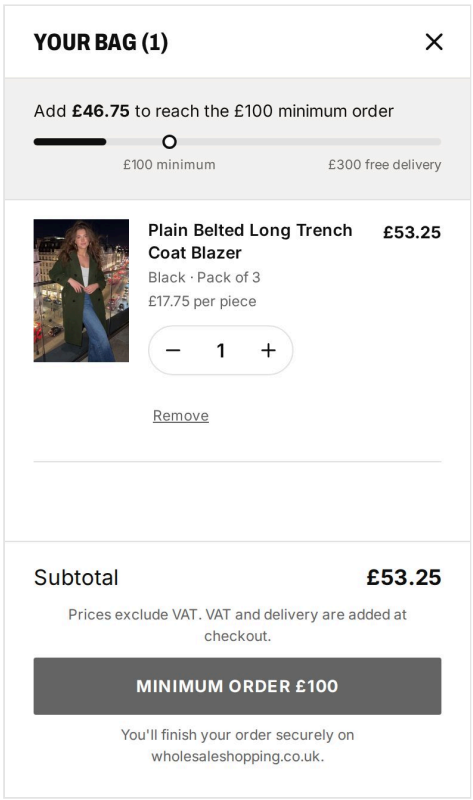
- **Problem:** the homepage shows only 4 "Autumn Picks" and 20 footwear products. There's no New In or Best Sellers row, and no product on the first screen.
- **Change:**
  - Category tiles with real product photos.
  - A tabbed **"Shop the latest"** row: New In, Best Sellers, Plus Size, Footwear and Made in Italy, 12 products each, swipeable on phones.
  - Search shows matching products as you type.
- **Expected benefit:** more products seen per visit, and buyers find relevant stock without leaving the homepage.

6. Add to the bag from the homepage (Quick Add)

- **Problem:** every product means opening its page, choosing colour and pack there, and coming back.
- **Change:**
  - **Quick Add** on every card: choose colour, pack size and number of packs in a bottom sheet on phones or a window on desktop.
  - It opens on the best-value pack in stock and shows the total.
  - On phones the Add button stays pinned at the bottom.
- **Expected benefit:** much faster ordering of many products, which is how wholesale buyers shop, so more items end up in each order.

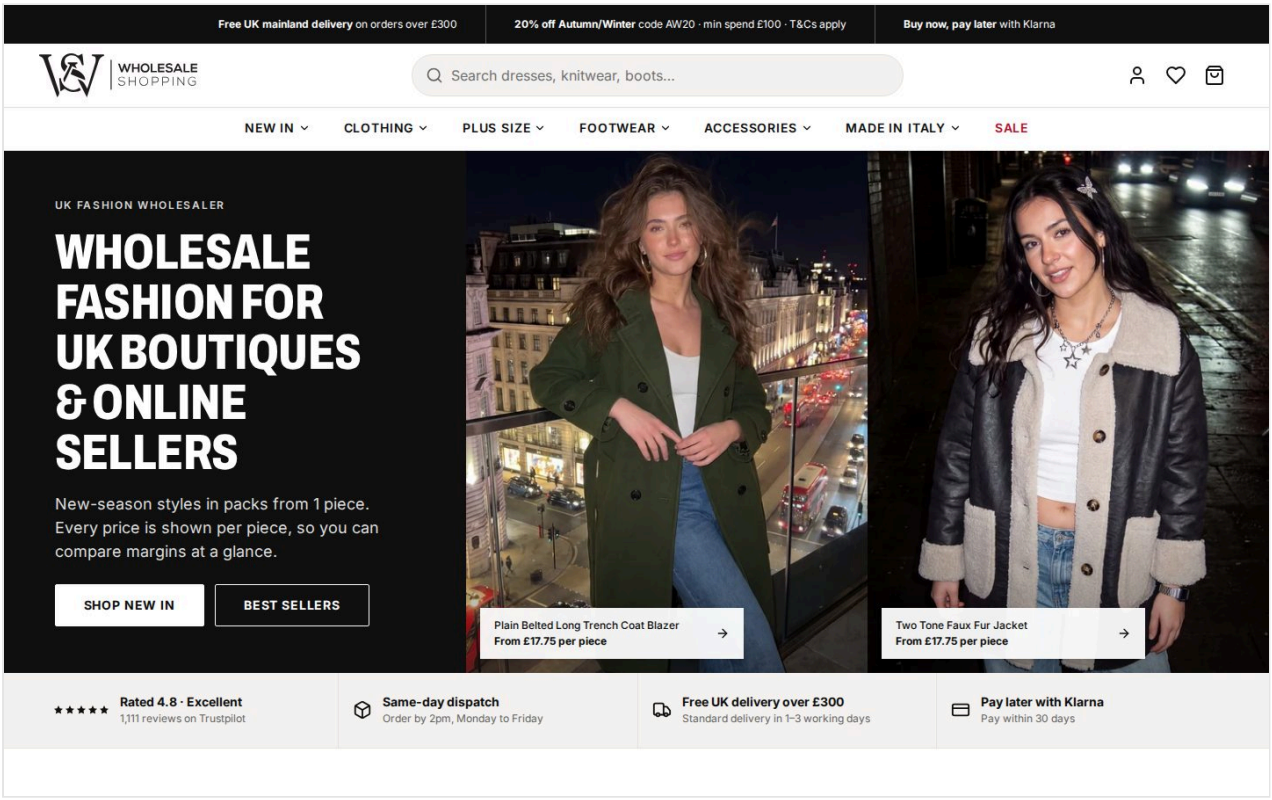
7. No surprises at checkout: the £100 minimum and £300 free delivery

- **Problem:**
  - The store blocks checkout under £100, but only says so on the cart page.
  - Nothing encourages buyers towards free delivery at £300; below that it costs £9.99–£12.99.
- **Change:**
  - The bag shows a progress bar with two milestones, £100 minimum and £300 free delivery. The message changes as the bag grows: *"Add £46.75 to reach the £100 minimum order"* → *"Add £X for free UK delivery"* → *"Free UK delivery unlocked"*.
  - Checkout hands the bag to the store's real Shopify checkout.
- **Expected benefit:** fewer abandoned checkouts at the minimum, and bigger orders as buyers top up towards £300.



8. Put trust where the decision is made

- **Problem:**
  - Trustpilot appears only in the footer, and the site quotes different review numbers (178 in its structured data, "1,300+" elsewhere).
  - Same-day dispatch, a strong benefit for traders, isn't on the homepage.
  - On phones the chat bubble covers the Search button.
- **Change:**
  - **A trust strip right under the hero:**
    - Trustpilot 4.8 "Excellent" from 1,111 reviews
    - same-day dispatch for orders placed by 2pm, Monday to Friday
    - free UK delivery over £300
    - pay later with Klarna within 30 days
  - Real review quotes further down.
  - A four-step **"How wholesale ordering works"** section: register → choose packs → check out from £100 → same-day dispatch.
  - A bottom bar that nothing covers.
- **Expected benefit:** first-time trade buyers feel safe enough to place a first order.



Also improved

- **Accessibility:** Lighthouse accessibility 100, every control at least 44 px tall on phones, menus that work with a keyboard, and no animation for visitors who switch motion off.
- **Speed:** Lighthouse performance 91 on phones and 92 on desktop, with no layout shift, and about 9 KB of JavaScript.

How I'd prove it

I'd A/B test the new homepage against the current one, tracking:

- clicks on the hero buttons
- product views per visit
- Quick Add → add-to-bag rate
- checkout starts
- average order value and the share of orders over £300

IF I HAD ONE MORE DAY

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First, I'd close the pricing gap. 26 of the 70 products on the homepage are sold as "Regular / Plus Size" rather than "Pack of N", so they show a price without a per-piece figure. I'd confirm with the team how those packs are made up, or read it from the product data, so every card uses the same per-piece language. Accurate prices are what resellers trust most.

Next, I'd make the changes measurable. I'd add analytics events for the hero buttons, Quick Add and the bag milestones, then A/B test the new hero and Quick Add against the current homepage. CRO decisions should be proven with data, not only with reasoning.

If time remained, I'd add a "Buy again" row for logged-in trade customers, because wholesale buyers reorder their best sellers.